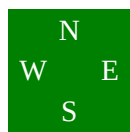


Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 8 6 4 2
♥ 8 5 2
♦ 8
♣ K Q 9 6

♠ A J 3
♥ K Q 9 7 4
♦ 7 6 4 2
♣ 10



♠ 10 7 5
♥ 6 3
♦ Q J 10 9
♣ J 5 4 2

♠ K Q
♥ A J 10
♦ A K 5 3
♣ A 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

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Check for Aces with Blackwood, partner replies 5♠. What next?

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Partner shows three Aces. You can't consider a Grand Slam, so bid 6♥.

The contract would be 6♥ played by North.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♦8, on which East plays the ♦9. You win the ♦K.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

If you look just at the North and South hands you would think this was a pretty easy slam to make. Pull trumps and play three rounds of ♦s, and as long as the ♦s split 3-2 you make twelve tricks. But when you consider the ♦8 opening lead you realize that it won't happen. The missing ♦s are Q J 10 9 and 8. The ONLY combination from which West would lead the ♦8 is when he has a singleton. So the ♦s won't be splitting and you need a different plan.

You need to get a ♦ discard somewhere, and dummy's third ♠ will take care of one of **YOUR** ♦ losers. But then to establish **YOUR** hand you are going to have to ruff all 3 ♣ losers.

Play the ♣A and ruff a ♣. Enter your hand with the ♥10 and ruff another ♣ high. Back to your hand with the ♥J and ruff another ♣ high. Dummy is out of trumps but there is still one more in a defender's hand. So come to your hand with the ♠Q and pull the last trump, discarding a ♦ from dummy.

With all the trumps pulled cash dummy's 2 ♠s and your ♦A, then give up a ♦ at the last trick.

This isn't strictly a dummy-reversal since you actually used your own hand to pull trumps and dummy's trumps for ruffing.

However it's a "role reversal", you pulled trumps with the short-trump hand and took three ruffs in the long-trump hand.

But call it whatever you like, that's the way to make this Deal.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 5 2

♥ 9 7 2

♦ 8 3

♣ 8 6 5

♠ A 6

♥ A 6 5

♦ K 7 6 2

♣ K Q 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 4 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 2

♠ Q J 7

♥ K Q J 10

♦ A Q 5

♣ A J 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

You have 16 points and partner has 20-21. If you bid 7NT right now just because it is something you always wanted to do, then I don't blame you. But if you're cautious you'll use Gerber 4♣. Partner bids 4♠;

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OK, you have all the Aces. You are missing 4 points at most, possibly a King and a Jack, or two Queens. You could continue with Gerber and find out about the Kings, or you could pick between 6NT and 7NT right now. You go for the gusto with 7NT!

The contract would be 7NT played by North.

South plays 7NT. West leads the ♠10. Do you play the ♠A or a low card?.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 4 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 12

If West has led from ♠ K 10 9 x, then all you have to do to make this contract is play a low card from dummy. But a decent defender would not make such a risky lead against a 7NT contract, so it is probable that East has the ♠K. You rise with the ♠A.

You hope the ♦s will split 3-3, but if they don't you still have the possibility of squeezing East if he holds 4 ♦s along with the ♠K you have assigned to him.

If it comes to a squeeze it is important to take your tricks in the correct order. First take 4 ♣ tricks, discarding the ♠J from your hand. You note that East discards a small ♠ on the fourth ♣.

Next take 4 ♥ winners, discarding dummy's useless ♠6 and keeping all 4 ♦s. On the fourth ♥ East must come down to a 4-card holding; he must either throw his ♠K, (you are happy) or he can throw one of his ♦s, (you are happy).

This was an automatic squeeze.

That means you didn't have to do anything special, just play your winners in the right order and keep your eyes open to see if the ♠K gets discarded.

Of course if the ♦s were breaking 3-3 all the time you haven't lost anything by playing for the squeeze.